

# Equal Employment Opportunity (EEO) Policy

Policy Reference: HR-POL-002

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| Policy ID:           | HR-POL-002          | Version:       | 3.0                           |
| Effective Date:      | 2024-01-01          | Last Reviewed: | 2023-11-15                    |
| Policy Owner:        | HR Director         | Approved By:   | Chief People Officer          |
| Compliance Required: | Yes – All Employees | Next Review:   | 12 months from effective date |

## 1. Policy Statement

Acme Corporation is an equal opportunity employer. We are committed to providing a workplace free from discrimination and ensuring that all employment decisions are based on merit, qualifications, and business need, without regard to any protected characteristic.

## 2. Protected Characteristics

The company does not discriminate on the basis of: race, color, religion, national origin, ancestry, sex, gender identity, sexual orientation, age (40+), disability, genetic information, pregnancy, marital status, veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by applicable federal, state, or local law.

## 3. Scope of Coverage

This policy covers all aspects of employment including: recruitment and hiring, compensation and benefits, training and development, promotions and transfers, discipline and termination, and all other terms and conditions of employment.

## 4. Reasonable Accommodation

The company provides reasonable accommodations to qualified individuals with disabilities and for sincerely held religious beliefs, unless doing so would create an undue hardship. Employees seeking accommodation should contact HR with supporting documentation. Accommodation requests are handled confidentially and reviewed within 10 business days.

## 5. Complaint Procedure

Employees who believe they have experienced discrimination should report the incident to HR or the Ethics Hotline within 180 days of the incident. HR will acknowledge receipt within 2 business days and complete the investigation within 30 days. Complainants will be updated on investigation status. Findings and any corrective actions will be communicated to involved parties.

## 6. Retaliation Prohibition

Retaliation against any employee for filing a complaint, participating in an investigation, or opposing discriminatory practices is strictly prohibited. Retaliation is itself a violation of this policy and will be treated as seriously as the underlying discriminatory conduct.

## **7. Manager Responsibilities**

All managers are responsible for: modeling non-discriminatory behavior, taking complaints seriously and escalating to HR immediately, not making employment decisions based on protected characteristics, completing EEO training annually, and fostering an inclusive team environment.

## **8. Training Requirements**

All employees must complete EEO training within 30 days of hire and annually thereafter. Managers must complete additional training on lawful interviewing, accommodation processes, and complaint handling. Training completion is tracked in the LMS and reflected in performance evaluations.